

Ultrabooks with gaming chops

Gigabyte is the latest player in the Ultrabooks segment and it has tied up with NVIDIA to bring out GeForce GTX 600M graphics on their Ivy Bridge processor sporting ultrabooks



Smartphones Vs Cameras

A list of new smartphones which come along with minimum of 8 MP and higher cameras with HD quality video recording. <http://digit.in/OQkp4a>

Acer Aspire V5 – 571G

Affordable laptop with great performance

Unlike the hateful glossy finish on the cousin the V3, this one has a classy matte black finish. You could probably blame it for being a tad drab, but simple doesn't always mean boring. Dimensions speak for themselves - 0.9-inches thick and 2.44kg weight.



This is powered by the Intel Core i5-2467M processor clocking at 1.6GHz, and is paired with 4GB of RAM on Intel's HM77 chipset (Panther Point), and yes, supports USB 3.0 natively. The Femi family Nvidia GeForce GT 620M (1GB) is paired with the Intel HD 3000 graphics in switchable mode.

The PC Mark Vantage score of 5855 points to solid mid range

performance. PC Mark 07's score of 1701 also verifies it. For the gamers, there is some bit of good news. The taxing 3D Mark 11 puts it in perspective - 1842 for Entry Mode, 1128 for Performance Mode and 345 in the extreme mode. The V3 is not too far behind the V5 that has a more powerful GT 630M (2GB), and will be able

to handle the latest games at medium settings.

The battery life clocked two and a half hours in the battery tests. Translate that into real life performance, and this should simply double. This one is clearly closing in on what most ultrabooks will offer.

The display is amazing - no reflectiveness, and the entirely matte quality makes this a hot favorite amongst us lot. Just be careful about keeping the brightness levels down, because it will get uncomfortable if not tamed.

For a price of around ₹40000, the Aspire V5 could be your ultrabook-ish laptop, without having to pay ultrabook prices.

Vishal Mathur

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i5-2467M @ 1.6GHz; **RAM:** 4GB; **Display:** 15.6-inch, 1366 x 768 pixel; **Graphics:** Nvidia GeForce GT 620M with 1GB RAM and Intel HD 3000; **Storage:** 500GB HDD; **Optical Drive:** Yes; **Connectivity:** 2 USB 2.0, 1 USB 3.0, HDMI, SD card slot, Ethernet and Wi-Fi

Contact

Acer India
Phone: 0120-3807200
Email: all_easycare@acer.co.in
Price: ₹ 42,990

8.0/10

Features8.0
Performance.....8.0
Build Quality7.0
Value for Money8.5

Sony Alpha 77

Sony's latest frame-buster

Specifications

Sensor: 24.3MP APS-C Exmor HD CMOS; **Burst rate:** 12 fps; **ISO Range:** 100 - 16000; **Shutter Speed:** 1/8000 to 30 secs;

Contact

Sony India

Phone: 1800-103-7799

Email: sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com

Price: ₹69,999 (body only), ₹99,999 (Body + 16-105mm lens)

8.0/10

Features8.0
Performance.....8.0
Build quality8.0
Value for money8.0

Sony's DSLRs have had a rocky start however, the Alpha 77 is a different story. There are several major innovations that make the Alpha 77 a mighty impressive APC-DSLR. It is the first crop-sensor camera to incorporate a 24.3 megapixel sensor, the highest pixel density in a crop sensor at release. One would think that a crop sensor that big would experience issues with noise at high ISO, but Sony's technical know-how has been put to good use as the A77 handles noise extremely well.

The second achievement that the Sony A77 boasts of is the ridiculously fast 12 frames per second it can shoot thanks to Sony's translucent mirror

technology. The light goes right through the translucent mirror and onto the sensor, allowing for faster frames per second. The drawback of this, however, is a dimmer than normal viewfinder, which Sony countered by packing in an Electronic View Finder. The EVF is capable of displaying a host of information, including a level gauge.

Coming to image quality, we found the colors of the A77 to be rich, though the green seemed to be a little on the stronger side. The 24 MP images are exquisitely full of detail. Video shot on the A77 also shares the same characteristics

The Sony A77 has been with ruggedness in mind, thanks to



water and dust seals present all around the camera. Also included is a three-way tilt-swivel articulated LCD, designed to help film makers get into those weird corners they've always fantasized shooting from.

The A77 is all yours for a price of INR69,999 for body only or INR 99,999 with the 16-105 lens, but we recommend buying body only along with better lenses.

Swapnil Mathur